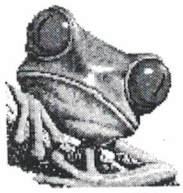
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Wall Flower



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By Brian Weilert

Setting: Junior High dance. We start with Melanie (Mel), a young girl who needs the aid of a walker due to a childhood disease, standing alone along the wall. She is later joined by her lifelong friend Tucker. For this duet, a chair could be used to represent the walker.

Mel: *(singing along to music "Maniac" by Michael Sembello)* She's a maniac, maniac on the floor. And she's dancin' like she never danced before. Do do do do do do do do do...
(*Tucker approaches)*
Tucker: Hey, Mel.
Mel: Tucker. *(Singing again)* Maniac, maniac on the floor.
Tucker: What do you think?
Mel: It's okay I guess. I thought the 80's theme would be lame but at least people are dancing this time.
Tucker: Yeah, *(awkward beat or two spent with the two of them bobbing their head to the music and singing under their breath)* Speaking of maniac, d'you see Beth out there grinding all over? She thinks she's all hot and stuff. She'd look stupid if she....well....you know.
Mel: Yeah, I know. If she really wasn't all hot and stuff.
Tucker: Yeah.
Mel: Well, at least get your tongue back in your mouth. Your fake disgust over her pelvic thrust would be far more convincing that way.
Tucker:*(sarcastic)* Ha, Ha.
Mel: You come with anyone?
Tucker: *(embarrassed)* My Mom.
Mel: I mean to the dance.
Tucker: I know what you mean. She's chaperoning tonight. *(Points to his mother. You can tell she catches his eyes as he give a weak smile and wave across the room.)*

Mel: Oh....bummer

Tucker: Yeah. It's not so bad. At least I don't get grilled when I get home.

(mimicking mom) "Did you have fun?, Did you dance with any pretty girls?" Blah, blah, blah. I swear one of these times I'm going to shock her, "Got no clue Mom. I was too busy drinking beer, smoking cigs and having sex in the parking lot to go in."

Mel: Tucker!

Tucker: Serious, she still treats me like I'm seven. I'm thirteen for crying out loud. I could like fight for my country and stuff in 4 ½ years.

Mel: I know what you mean. My dad thinks just because I can't walk very good that I still fill my diaper. So, the other day....

Tucker: *(interrupting, serious, whispering so others won't hear)* You wear a diaper?

Mel: No doof. I mean he treats me like a baby.

Tucker: Whew, glad to hear that. About the diaper thing not about the baby thing. *(a new song comes on)* Oh, this song is by that dude that wore make up and stuff; Boy George Bush or something like that.

Mel: Try to stay with me here Tucker. *(motions with hands)* Follow the bouncing red ball. I was trying to tell you how he still thinks of me like.. like I'm fresh from the womb..

Tucker: Gross.

Mel: Right, anyway the other day I bought this bra at Dollar General.

Tucker: *(putting fingers in ears)* Okay, too much info Mel.

Mel: Grow up Tucker, girls wear bras. I spared you the fact that I got tampons too.

Tucker: *(fingers quickly back in ears, singing song "Do You Really Want to Hurt Me" by Culture Club)* Do you really want to hurt me? Do you really want to make me cry? *(Taking one finger out, speaking now)* You done?

Mel: Sorry, It's just that you're my best friend and I don't have anyone to really talk with now that mom's .....*(drifting off)*

Tucker: Yeah, I get you. I forget sometimes. *(Looks around to find his own mom, sees her and waves)*

Mel: Dad tries an all but he's so busy and well, he really is clueless. The other day he thought we'd connect, he tried to be cool, "modern dad" and he went out and bought me underwear.

Tucker: So, my mom does that. Come to think of it, so do both my grandmas every Christmas. Well, that and tube socks.

Mel: Tucker, he bought me thong underwear.

Tucker: *(fingers quickly back in ears, singing again)* Do you really want to make me cry...

Mel: *(pulls his fingers out of ears)* Would you stop that!

Tucker: Me stop it, how 'bout you? Your grossing me out for cripes sake. I'm a visual learner.

Mel: So?

Tucker: So! When you say thong, I see you in a thong! There I said it.

Mel: Oh....*(pauses, thinking)* Is that really so gross?

Tucker: YES! *(Sees he has hurt her feelings)* I mean no, I mean.... Cripes Mel what am I supposed to say?

Mel: Nothing, you should stop while your behind.

Tucker: Mel, I don't want to see any girl in a thong.

Mel: I bet if ol' pelvic pumping Beth was out there in one your eyes would be bulging out of your head like Mr. Mew on Highway 4.

Tucker: Ouch, low blow Mel bringing in my dead cat. You know Mr. Mew and I were tight.

Mel: Serves you right; calling me gross.

Tucker: I didn't call you GROSS!
Mel: DID!
Tucker: DID NOT!

(Both turn sharply away from each other. A new song has come on and it is the duet You and I by Eddie Rabbitt and Crystal Gayle. Tucker begins singing Mel joins)

Tucker: Just you and I
Mel: Just you and I
Both: Sharing our love together
Tucker: And I know in time.
Mel: And I know in time.
Both: We'll build the dreams we treasure. *(Both look at each other and start laughing)*
Mel: You goober
Tucker: Gooberesse.
Mel: Nice one (pause) I'm sorry about bring up Mr. Mew.
Tucker: No problem, let's just let laying cats lay.
Mel: Cute. (Pause) Tucker?
Tucker: What?
Mel: Do boys thing of me as....well.....gross?
Tucker: NO! They think your nice-n-all.
Mel: Oh, nice huh?
Tucker: Yeah.
Mel: Guess that's better than being...well... DEAD! Nice?! I'm nice?! Ellie Pierce is nice because she is pushing 240 pounds! Kelly is nice because her teeth are the color of the skid marks in my dad's Fruit of the Looms! Nice?! I don't want to be nice!
Tucker: Tell me how you really feel. Come on, you are WAAAAAY over reacting.
Mel: *(yelling)* You have no idea what it's like! You think you know but you don't!
Tucker: Keep it down people are going to stare.
Mel: *(yelling to everyone at the dance)* They always stare at me! *(back to Tucker)* They either stare or won't look at all. I don't know which one I hate worse.
Tucker: People don't stare.
Mel: The hell they don't!
Tucker: Mel!
Mel: What?! HELL, HELL, HELL, HELL! Tucker I'm not a little girl anymore. I see the way boys look at other girls. The way YOU look at other girls. I may be crippled but I'm not blind!
Tucker: Don't use that word Mel, you hate that word.

Mel: Isn't that what I am? Isn't that what I'll always be to everyone? Melanie the nice crippled girl from school?
Tucker: I don't ever see you that way.

Mel: Tucker don't you get it? I'm afraid I'm never going to date, I'm never going to have a first kiss, someone to love me, grow old with me, nothing.

Tucker: Oh.... *(awkward pause, continues trying to lighten the moment)* 'member that time I hit you in the head with that huge dirt clod in 4th grade?..... *(wait for response)*

Mel: *(drifted off not responding)*

Tucker: *(continues)*...I was nail'n that stop sign on the corner up from my house and you come rounding the hedge and boom... *(waiting for response)*

Mel: *(no response)*

Tucker: *(trying to draw her back in fabricates part of the story)*...Yeah, and then you started crying and crying for you mommy. You just kept.. *(interrupted)*

Mel: *(turn sharply)* I don't have a mom! She's dead!! *(turns away)*

Tucker: *(realizing his mistake scrambles to make up for it)* Oh, crap Mel I'm mega-sorry. I totally brain-farted. You know I was just messin'. I would never ever hurt you. I'd rather die than to see you cry. *(No response)* Come on Mel, I'm stupid ok? Hit me or somethin' please.

Mel: *(without hesitation she turns and hits him hard on the arm, you can tell it makes her feel better)*

Tucker: *(rubbing arm)* Crap! That hurt.

Mel: I didn't cry that day. As I remember it, I picked up the clod and nailed you dead-center of your chest. You were sucking for air and you were the one crying for your mommy.

Tucker: *(still rubbing his arm)* True, true. I was just sayin' the cryin' thing to get you to talk. I didn't mean to screw up and throw in the "M" word like a complete idiot. Forgive me?

Mel: We're cool, besides it wasn't ALL your fault. I might have slightly over reacted an eentsy, teensy tiny bit.

Tucker: Can I get an Amen to that sister?

Mel: *(makes a fist)* Don't push it.

Tucker: Man I love this song.

Mel: This song? Why this song?

Tucker: I'm not a gay nerd or anything its just that my mom was a huge Eddie Rabbitt fan.

Mel: *(making alarms sounds)* Whoop, whoop, whoop! Warning total geek alert, we have a geek in sector 12. He knows who sings this song.

Tucker: Hey you new the words too.

Mel: Okay fine but not the singer.

Tucker: My mom probably requested it. Her and dad used to sing the duet together. Course, mom had to sing the Crystal Gayle part.

Mel: Whoop, whoop, whoop he know both singers.

Tucker: *(starts singing song to Mel. When he does female part he changes his voice to a falsetto)* Just you and I *(falsetto)* Just you and I We can entrust each other, With you in my life, *(falsetto)* With you in my life, They'll never be another.

Mel: *(is staring at Tucker)* You mean that?

Tucker: What?

Mel: You and me?

Tucker: You and me what?

Mel: Never mind.

Tucker: What?!

Mel: Nothing, it was stupid. I was caught up in the moment is all.

Tucker: Earth to Mel, you're freaking' me out here. What gives?

Mel: Don't you ever wonder what your life is going to be like?

Tucker: Cripes Mel, I'm still a kid.

Mel: Funny a moment ago you were drinkin' beer, smoking cigarettes and having sex before going off to war.
Tucker: *(sarcastic)* Funny....not
Mel: I'm serious. You never wonder about who you are going to marry, kids and stuff like that?
Tucker: Well, Joey had this paper game where you fold it up to look like a Venus fly trap that opens up both ways and it has numbers on the top. Anyway under the numbers are flaps and you give him a number and he works it back and forth *(demonstrating with his hands)* and under the flaps...*(interrupted)*
Mel: Tucker! I know the stupid game. What's your point?
Tucker: The point is that according to that, and Joey assures me it is very scientific, I will live in Bangor, Maine working as a race car driver. I'll have eight children and a lovely wife named, drum roll please *(makes drum noise)* Britney Spears! He shoots! He scores!*(makes crowd noise)*
Mel: Can't you ever be serious?
Tucker: Eight kids is very serious.
Mel: Forget it, you are a kid. *(turns away)*
Tucker: *(sarcastic)* Ouch, that really hurt right here. *(points to his heart)*
Mel: *(turns sharply back)* I love you, you imbecile
Tucker: *(stunned)*
Mel: Did you hear me?
Tucker: I'm kind of hoping you said, " My dove flew in the mall."
Mel: What?
Tucker: You try to rhyme the word imbecile.
Mel: You heard me stupid.
Tucker: Wow, all that flattery, what's a guy to do?
Mel: Well?
Tucker: Well....give me a second here.
Mel: I've been holding that in for four years.
Tucker: I'm surprise it didn't stink and make more noise coming out.
Mel: Tucker, no jokes. I can't have you joke about this. This is me fully exposed. *(Tucker cringes)*
Tucker: Visual learner Mel, visual learner.
Mel: Sorry.
Tucker: Cripes, I never thought of it. You and I are tight and all but... but... whew.. are you sure you didn't say dove? *(pause)* Ok, no jokes. Mel your nice and all, no, no I didn't mean that, you're cool not nice. In no way are you nice, nor have you ever been nice. Your cool, yeah your cool.
Mel: Tucker, your like Mr. Botch in history. You just talked a whole lot and said absolutely nothing.
Tucker: It's a gift. Mom says I have a possible career in politics.
Mel: Tucker.
Tucker: Ok Mel. Got it, serious. I can do serious, but just for a couple of minutes otherwise my doctor says my spleen might explode.
Mel: Tucker!

Tucker: I'm gettin' there. Ok got it, serious. Mel you've been my best friend for my whole life. I would do anything for you and I trust you more than anyone on the planet Earth. Plus, you've got to be smarter than me. If you love me, then cripes, I guess I got to at least consider the fact that you might be on to something. Mel, could I have this dance?

Mel: You know I can't.

Tucker: Can't or just never have?

Mel: I do in front of my mirror in my room, but it looks funny.

Tucker: See, that's what I love about you. No way I would ever tell you what I do in front of my mirror.

Mel: Thanks for sparing me..... *(pause)* Did you say love?

Tucker: *(ignoring the question)* How 'bout it. You just lean on me and we'll do it. It's a slow song so we'll just look like everyone else.

Mel: Except you better not put your hands on my buns.

Tucker: Right, no buns. It's a deal.

Mel: Deal.

(Mel puts walker aside and Tucker helps her by holding her up as they start to slow dance, Mel's head is on Tucker shoulder. Starts singing "Hello by Lionel Richie)

Mel: I've been alone with you inside my mind
And in my dreams I've kissed your lips a thousand times
I sometimes see you pass outside my door
Hello, is it me you're looking for?

Tucker: *(interrupting)* How about that first kiss?

Mel: It depends. Is this a date?

Tucker: I don't know. Sure, I guess you could call it that if you want.

Mel: Well, then forget it. I never kiss on the first date.

Tucker: Nice one.

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